

Outlook

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Are we blocking the right cards for the right reasons?

Morning,

I need help with something that sounds simple but probably is not.

Card blocking protects customers, but repeated legitimate attempts and later complaints may reveal controls that are too blunt. The operating teams agree that more journeys are failing; they disagree on whether the customer, the bank or a downstream party owns the failure. There are enough data exceptions to make a polished average dangerous; preserve the unresolved cases.

The questions I would ask in the room are:

1. What would we expect to see if blocked cards follow genuinely unusual sequences?
2. What evidence would instead support that ordinary PIN errors create avoidable blocks?
3. How do we rule out that customers receive inconsistent recovery paths?

Please work towards where thresholds, escalation or customer communication should change. A useful output would be a short decision pack with no more than five slides and an attached evidence table.

Use ATM attempts, host responses, PIN attempts, blocked-card state and latency; transaction-level timestamps, channels, amounts, statuses and error context; monthly account snapshots, status events, limits, product enrolments and signatories; customer contacts, complaints and suggestions. One caution: Do not label a block as incorrect without the rule decision and investigation outcome.

Regards